

Introduction

Chanakya was known by multiple names like Kautilya and Vishnugupta and played multiple roles like being a teacher, philosopher, economist, jurist and royal advisor. He is considered the pioneer of the field of political science and economics in India, and his work is thought of as an important precursor to classical economics.

Chanakya assisted the first Mauryan emperor Chandragupta in his rise to power. He is widely credited for having played an important role in the establishment of the Maurya Empire. Chanakya served as the chief advisor to both emperors Chandragupta and his son Bindusara.

Arthashastra and Chanakya Neeti were the two important books written by him. Arthashastra was discovered in 1905 by librarian Rudrapatna Shamasastri in an uncatalogued group of ancient palm-leaf manuscripts donated by an unknown pandit to the Oriental Research Institute Mysore.

The Arthashastra discusses monetary and fiscal policies, welfare, international relations, and war strategies in detail. The text also outlines the duties of a ruler. Some scholars believe that

Arthashastra is actually a compilation of a number of earlier texts written by various authors, and Chanakya might have been one of these authors.

Chanakya Niti is a collection of aphorisms, said to be selected by Chanakya from the various shastras. The topics discussed are ethics, morality, governance and several others.

Chanakya is regarded as a great thinker and diplomat in India. Many Indian nationalists regard him as one of the earliest people who envisaged the united India spanning the entire subcontinent. India's former National Security Advisor Shiv Shankar Menon praised Chanakya's Arthashastra for

its clear and precise rules which apply even today. Furthermore, he recommended reading of the book for broadening the vision on strategic issues.

The diplomatic enclave in New Delhi is named Chanakyapuri in honour of Chanakya. Institutes named after him include Training Ship Chanakya, Chanakya National Law University and Chanakya Institute of Public Leadership. Chanakya Circle in Mysore has been named after him.

Several modern adaptations of the legend of Chanakya narrate his story in a semi-fictional form, extending these legends. In Chandragupta (1911), a play by Dwijendralal Ray, the Nanda king exiles his half-brother Chandragupta, who joins the army of Alexander the Great. Later, with help from Chanakya and Katyayan (the former Prime Minister of Magadha), Chandragupta defeats Nanda, who is put to death by Chanakya.

The reading of Chanakya Neeti is as relevant today as it was at the time it was written. This book is an attempt to bring the same to the readers of today.

The Individual

(The basic purpose of Chanakya-Niti is to impart knowledge on every practical aspect of life. And in this context, he has touched upon various factors dealing with faith and culture, from the individual's point of view.)

Riches, vitality, life, body—all are fickle and fey; only Dharma is constant and everlasting.

*

God's abode is not the idols of wood, stone or earth. He dwells only in feeling.

*

But, even if one puts one's faith in the idols of gods made of metal, wood or stone and worshipsthem with total devotion, one is awarded with the desired result.

*

Anger is death, Lust is (the river of hell) Vaitarani, Knowledge is the cow of plenty and Satisfaction is (the divine orchard) Nandanvan.

PRAYER

प्रणम्य शिरसा विष्णुं त्रैलोक्याधिपतिं प्रभुम्।
नाना शास्त्रेद्धृतं वक्ष्ये राजनीति समुच्चयम् ॥ १ ॥

*Pranammya Shirsaa Vishnum Trailokyaadhipatim Prabhum.
Naanaa Shaastroddhrootam Vikshye Rajneeti Samuchchyam.*

I salute to the Lord of the three realms, Lord Vishnu, and now commence to describe the principles of the statecraft culled from various ancient books of knowledge.

धर्मेतत्परता मुखे मधुरता दाने समुत्साहता
मित्रोऽवञ्चकता गुरौ विनयता चित्तेऽपि गम्भिरता ।
आचरे शुचिता गुणे रिसकता शास्त्रोषु विज्ञातृता
रूपे सुन्दरता शिवे भनता त्वयस्ति भो राघव ॥ २ ॥

*Dharme Tattpartaa Mukhe Madhurtaa Daane Samuttsaahataa
Mitreavanchakataa Guru Vinyataa Chitteapi Gambheerataa.
Aachaare Shuchitaa Gune Rasiktaa Shaastreshu Vigyataa
Roope Sundartaa Shive Bhajantaa Tvayasti Bho Raaghav.*

Devotion in faith, sweetness in voice, alacrity in alms-giving, guilelessness in relation with friends, humility for the Guru, depth in character; piety in behaviour, regard for merit, erudition in scriptural knowledge, beauty in appearance and belief in Lord Shiva (or in the welfare of all) are, O Raghav (Lord Rama), your attributes!

काष्ठं कल्पतरूः सुमेरूरचलश्चिन्तामणिः प्रस्तरः
सूर्यस्तीव्रकरः शशिः क्षयक निरवारिधिः ।
कामो नष्टतनुर्बलिर्दितिसुतो नित्य पशुः कामगोः
नैतास्ते तुलयामि भो रघपते कस्योपभा दीयते ॥ ३ ॥

*Kaashtham Kalpataruh Sumerurachalashinintaamanih Prashtarah
Soonyasteevrakarah Shashih Kshayakarah Kshaarohi Nirvaaridhih.
Kaamo Nashtatanurbalirditishuto Nittya Prashuh Kaamagoh
Naittaaste Tulayaami Bho Raghupate Kassyopabhaa Deeyate.*

Kalpataru (The divine tree fulfilling all desires) is wooden: the Sumeru is a hill, the philosopher's stone is but a stone; the sun has scorching rays, the moon is waxing and waning, the sea (water) is saline, the Kamadeva (the god of love) is bodyless; Bali is a demon, the cow of plenty is an animal--

O Ram! I fail to compare you with anyone (i.e., everything with best of the attributes have some inherent defect in it): You are incomparable.

का चिन्ता मम जीवने यदि हरिर्विश्वम्भरो गीयते
नो चेदर्भकजीवनार्थं जनीस्तन्यं कुथं निःसरेत्।
इत्यालोच्य मुहुर्महुर्यदु पते लक्ष्मीपते केवलं
त्वत्पादाम्बुजसेवनेन सततं कालो मया नीयते ॥ ४ ॥

*Kaa chintaa Mam Jeevane Yadi Harirvishvambharo geeyate
No chedarbhakjeevanarth Jananeestannyam Kutham Nihsaret.
Ittyaalochaya Muhurmuhuryadu Pate Laxmipate Kevalam
Tvattapaadaambujsevanen Satatam Kaalo Mayaa Neeyate.*

Why should I worry for life as Lord Hari is the sustainer of the world. Had it not been so then how come a mother's breasts be filled with milk for her infant automatically? Believing this (that he who creates life also provides for its sustenance) O spouse of Lakshmi! I pass my life devoted to your feet!

GOD

पुष्पे गन्धं तिले तैलं काष्ठे वह्निः पयोघृतम्।
इक्षौ गुडं तथादेहे पश्यात्मानं विवेकतः ॥ ५ ॥

*Pushpe Gandham Tile Tailam Kaashthe Vahannih Payoghritam.
Ikshau Gudam Tathaa Dehe Pashyaattmanam Vivekatah.*

God dwells in our bodies, life fragrance in flowers, oil in oil seeds, fire in wood, ghee in milk, jaggery in the sugarcane. The wise should understand this.

न देवो विद्यते काष्ठे न पाषाणे न मृण्मये।
भावे ही विद्यते देवस्तस्माद् भावो ही कारणम् ॥ 6 ॥

*Na Devo Viddyate Kaashthe Na Paashaane Na Mrinnyamaye.
Bhave Hee Viddyate Devastasmaad Bhaavo Hee Kaaranam.*

God doesn't dwell in the wooden, stony or earthen idols. His abode is in our feelings, our thoughts. [It is only through the feeling that we deem God existing in these idols.]

अग्निहोत्रां बिना वेदाः न च दानं बिना क्रिया।
न भावेन बिना सिद्धिस्तस्माद् भावो ही कारणम् ॥ 7 ॥

*Agnihottram Binaa Vedaah Na cha Daanam Bina Kriyaa.
Na Bhaaven Bina Siddhistasmaad Bhaavo Hee Kaaranam.*

Studying the Vedas without maintaining the sacred fire and offering oblation to it is as useless as performing the sacrifice without giving alms. One must attempt with feeling of total devotion to get success in any venture.

काष्ठपाषाणं धतूनां कृत्वा भावेन सेवनम्।
श्रद्धया च तथा सिद्धिस्तस्य विष्णोः प्रसादतः ॥ 8 ॥

*Kaashthapaashaanam Dhaatunaam Krittvaa Bhaaven Sevanam.
Shraddhayaa Cha Tathaa Siddhistasya Vishnoh Prasasadatah.*

If one worships even the wooden, stony or the metallic idols with feeling, then by the grace of God one gets the desired objects or adeptness.

अग्निर्देवो द्विजातीनां मनीषिणं दि दैवतम्।
प्रतिमा स्वल्पबुद्धीनां सर्वत्रा समदर्शिनः ॥ 9 ॥

*Agnirdevo Dvijaatinaam Maneeshinaam Hridim Daivatam.
Pratimaa Svalpabuddheenaam Sarvatra Samadarshinah.*

The deity of the Twice-born(brahmans) is fire. The wise behold their deity inside their hearts. Those with lesser intelligence deem deity existing in the idols and those viewing the world impartially behold their deity permeating the whole world.

कलौ दशसहस्राणि हरिस्तयजति मेदिनीम्।
तददर्धे जावी तोयं तददर्धे ग्रामदेवता ॥ 10 ॥

*Kalan Dashasahastraani Haristasyajati Modineem.
Tadaddardhe Jaahavee Toyam Tadaadaardhe Graamdevataa*

Lord Hari (vishnu) leaves the earth after completing ten thousand years of the Kaliyuga: the Ganga withdraws her waters after completing half of this period [i.e., five thousand years of the Kaliyuga]and the Gramdevtas (local deities) leave the earth after completing half of this period

(i.e., two thousand five hundred years of the Kaliyuga.)

DHARM

चला लक्ष्मीश्चलाः प्राणाश्चले जीवितमनिदरे।
चलाचले च संसारे धर्म एको हि निश्चलः ॥ 11 ॥

*Chalaa Laxmishchalaah Praanaashchale Jeevitmandire.
Chalaachale cha Sansaare Dharma Eko Hi Nishchalah.*

All riches, vitality, life and body are fickle and fey: Only the Dharma is constant and everlasting.

**अनित्यानि शरीराणि विभवो नैव शाश्वतः।
नित्यं सन्निहितो मृत्युः कर्तव्यो धर्मसंग्रहः ॥ 12 ॥**

*Anityaani Shareeraani Vibhvo Naiv Saashvatah.
Nityam Sannihito Mrityuh Kartavyo Dharmasangrah.*

Constantly bounded by death, all power and pelf are fey. Hence one should adhere to one's Dharma, which is everlasting.

**जीवन्तं मृतवन्मन्ये देहनं धर्मवर्जितम्।
मृतो धर्मेणसंयुक्तो दीर्घजीवी न संशयः ॥ 13 ॥**

*Jeevantam Mritvannamanye Dehinam Dharmavarjitam Mrito
Dharmen Sanyuto Deerghajeevee Na Sanshayah.*

I deem as dead a being devoid of Dharma! He who adheres to one's Dharma is long-aged even if he is dead – there is no doubt about it!

CONSEQUENCE OF AN ACTION

**यथा धेनु सहस्रोषु वत्सो गच्छति मातरम्।
तथा यच्च कृतं कर्म कर्तारम् नुगच्छति ॥ 14 ॥**

*Yathaa Dhenu Sahastreshu Vattso Gachhati Maatram.
Tathaa Yachcha Kritam Karma Kartaaramanugachhati.*

Like a calf finds the mother-cow even if there be thousands of cows, so the consequence of an action searches its doer unerringly.

[i.e., one can't escape the consequence of an action do whatever one may.]

स्वयं कर्म करोत्यात्मा स्वयं तत्फलमश्नुते।
स्वयं भ्रमति संसारे स्वयं तस्माद्विमुच्यते॥ 15 ॥

*Svayam Karma Karottyaattamaa Svayam Tatphalamashnute
Svayam Bhramati Sansaare Svayam Tasmaadvimuchchayate.*

Man himself does action and himself bears its consequences. He himself roams about in the world and gets liberated from this cycle of birth and death

[Chanakya says that man is free to act but he must bear its consequences, whether good or bad. It is only his balance-sheet of the action and its consequence has been set at naught that he becomes liberated. Hence to achieve this liberation is also well within the control of man.]

कर्मायतं फलं पुसां बुद्धिः कर्मानुसारिणी।
तथापि सुध्याचार्यः सुविचार्येव कुर्वते॥ 16 ॥

*Karmaayattam Phalam Pusaani Buddhih Karmaanusaarini.
Tathapi Sudhiyaachaaryaah Suvichaaryava Kurvate.*

Although man reaps as he sows and his wisdom is also controlled by his action, yet the prudent and wisemen act very thoughtfully, fully weighing the good and bad consequences. [It means that though the resultant of the deeds committed in previous life decide the good and bad consequence in this life, still one must act after a thoughtful deliberation.

आत्मापराध्वक्षस्य पफलान्येतानि देहिनाम्।
दारिद्र्यरोग दुःखानि बन्धव्यसनानि च ॥ 17 ॥

*Aattmaaparaadhavrikshasya Phalaanyetaani Dehinaam.
Daaridrayarogah Duhkhaani Bandhanvuasnaani cha.*

Poverty, disease, grief, bondage and all the infatuative addictions are the fruits of the tree of sin of a person.

जन्मजन्मनि चाभ्यस्तंदानमययन तपः।
तेनैवाभ्यासयोन देही वाभ्यस्यते ॥ 18 ॥

*Janmajanmani Chaabhyastam Daanmaddhyayan Taphah.
Tenaivaabhyaasyagen Dehi Vaabhyaste.*

It is after the constant practice of many lives that man attains to the capacity to learn, to do penance or to dole out alms.

LUCK OR FATE

आयुः कर्म वितच विद्या निध्रमेव च
पचतानि हि सृज्यन्ते गर्भस्थस्यैव देहिनः ॥ 19 ॥

*Aayuh Karma Vittancha Viddya Nidhanmeva cha.
Panchtaani Hi Srijjyante Garbhasthasyaiv Dehinah.*

Age, profession, financial status, level of education and death – these five basic parameters of human life are ordained when the being is in the embryonic form.

रंक करोति राजानं राजानं रंकमेव च।
धनिनं निर्धनचैव निर्धन धनिनं विधिः ॥ 20 ॥

*Ranka Karoti Raajaanam Rajaanam Rankmev Cha.
Dhaninam Nirdhanam Chaiv Nirdhanam Dhaninam vidhih*

It is one's fate that makes a beggar a king or a king a beggar; a rich man a pauper or a pauper rich.

पत्रां नैव यवा करीरविट पे दोषो वसन्तस्य किं
नोलूकोप्यवलोकयते यदि दिवा सूर्यस्य किं दूषणाम्?
वर्षा नैव पतति चातकमुखे मेघस्य किं दूषणाम्
यत्पूर्व विधिना ललाट लिखितं तन्मार्जितु कःक्षमः? ॥ 21 ॥

*Patram Naiv Yava Karreravit Pe dosho Vasantasya kim
Nolokaappyavalokayate Yadi Diva Sooryasya Kim Dooshanam?
Varshaa naiv Patati Chaatakamukhe Meghasya Kim Dooshanam.
Yattpoorva Vidhinaa Lalaat Likhitam Tanmanaarjitu Kah Kshamah?*

If leaves do not sprout in the Kareel (Capparis ahylla) tree, is it the flaw of the Spring Season? If an owl fails to see in daylight, is it the flaw of the sun ? If the rain- drop doesn't fall in the mouth of Chatak

(Cuculus melanoleucus) is it the flaw of the clouds? Who can alter the fate ordained as the destiny? [Chanakya says that individual deficiency is caused by destiny for which external a circumstances cannot be held responsible.]

ईप्सितं मनसः सर्व कस्य सम्पद्यते सुखम्।
दैवायतं यतः सर्व तस्मात् सन्तोषमाश्रयेत् ॥ 22 ॥

*Eepsitam Mansah Sarva Kasya Sampaddyate Sukham.
Daivaayattam Yatah Sarva Tasmaat Santoshmaashrayet.*

Who gets all that one aspires for? Everything one gets is what is destined for one. Hence all must seek satisfaction in whatever they receive.

SELF-WELFARE

यावत्स्वस्थो ह्ययं देहः तावन्मृत्युश्च दूरतः।
तावदात्महितं कुर्यात् प्राणान्ते किं करिष्यति॥ 23 ॥

*Yaavattsvastho Yahayam Dehah Taavanmriuttushcha Dooratah.
Taavdaattmahitam Kuryaat Praanante Kim Karishyati.*

Death is away till one's body is healthy. Hence one should achieve one's welfare till one is healthy, for death ceases all activities.

SELF-KNOWLEDGE

नास्ति काम समो व्याधिर्नास्ति मोहसमो रिपुः।
नास्ति कोप समो वह्निः नास्ति ज्ञानात्परं सुखम्॥ 24 ॥

*Naasti Kaam Samo Vyaadhirnaasti Mohasamo Ripuh.
Naasti Kop Samo Vahinnih Naasti Gyaanaattparam Sulkham.*

No disease is more deadly than (the sexual) desire, no enemy is more dangerous than infatuation, no fire is hotter than the fire of wrath and no happiness is better than the self-knowledge.

TRUTH

सत्येन धर्यते पृथ्वी सत्येन तपते रविः।
सत्येन वाति वायुश्च सर्वसत्ये प्रतिष्ठितम् ॥ 25 ॥

*Sattyen Dhaaryate Prithvee Sttyen Tapate Ravi
Sattyen Vaati Vaayushcha Sarvam Sattye Prathishthitam.*

Truth stabilises the world, makes the sun shine and the wind blow.
Truth establishes well everything in life.

[Chanakya says that truth alone establishes the order in the Creation.]

DESTINY

तादृशी जायते बुद्धिर्व्यवसायोऽपि तादृशः।
सहायास्तादृशाः एव यादृशी भवितव्यता ॥ 26 ॥

*Taadrishee Jaayte Buddhivaryavsaayoapi Taadrishah.
Sahaayaasstaadrishaah Eva Yaadrishee Bhavitavyataa.*

One gets everything according to 'one's destiny. One's action, response, reaction—all are guided by the factors of destiny.

[meaning the rule of destiny is supreme in human life. If one is destined to reap a good harvest one would get situation conducive to his receiving good result and vice versa.]

MOKSHA (LIBERATION)

मुक्तिमिच्छसि चेत्तत विषयान् विषवत् त्यज।
क्षमार्जवदयाशैचं सत्यं पीयूषवत् पिब ॥ 27 ॥

*Muktimichasi Cheetat Vishayaan Vishvat Tyaji.
Kshamaarjvadyaashaucham Sattyam Peeyooshvat Pib.*

O dear, if you really seek liberation of your soul then shun all the sensual attractions as though they are poison and cultivate the spirit of forgiveness, the rectitude of conduct, compassion, piety truth and similar other qualities which are nectar for human life.

**बन्धाय विषयासंगः मुक्त्यै निर्विषयं मनः।
मनएवं मनुष्याणां कारणं बन्धमोक्षयोः ॥ 28 ॥**

*Bandhanaaya Vishyaasangah Muktayai Nirvishyam Manah.
Man Eva Manusshyaanaam Kaaranam Bandmokshyoh.*

Bondage is indulgence in vices and renunciation of them is liberation. Thus it is mind, which drives one to bondage or to liberation.

SAMADHI (MEDITATION)

**देहाभिमानगलिते ज्ञानेन परमात्मनः।
यत्रा-यत्रा मनो याति तत्रा-तत्रा समाध्यः ॥ 29 ॥**

*Dehaabhimaangalite Gyaanen Paramaattmanah.
Yatra-Yatro Mano Yaati Tatra-Tatra Samaadhayah.*

The communion with, and realisation of God, melts away the arrogance of the physical attributes. Achieving this stage, one is able to concentrate easily in meditation, wherever and whenever one wants.

VAIRAGYA (AVERSION TO THE TEMPORAL WORLD)

धर्माख्याने श्मशाने च रोगिणां या मतिर्भवेत्।
सा सर्वदैव तिष्ठेच्चेत् को न मुच्येत बन्धात् ॥ 30 ॥

*Dharmakkhyaane Shmashaane Cha Roginaam Yaa Matirbhavet.
Saa Sarvadaiv Thishtbechchet Ko Na Muchyate Bandhanaat*

One develops a version to the temporal world by listening to the sacred tales, viewing the diseased persons and visiting the crematorium. And if one remains averse to wordly considerations, he is bound to be free from all the bondages.

SOUL

पुष्पे गन्धं तिले तैल काष्ठे वह्निः पयोघृतम्।
इक्षौ गुडं तथा देहे पश्यात्मानं विवेकतः ॥ 31 ॥

*Pushpe Gandham Tile Tail Kaashthe VAhinah Payoghritam.
Ekshau Gudam Tathaa Dehe Pasyaatmaanam Vivektah.*

Discern soul in the body like you feel fragrance in flower, oil in the oilseed. fire in wood, ghee in milk and jaggery in sugarcane.

QUIETUDE

यस्तु संवत्सरं पूर्णं नित्यं मौनेन भुञ्जते।
युगकोटिसहस्रान्तु स्वर्गलोके महीयते ॥ 32 ॥

*Yastu Samvattsaram Poorna Nittyam Maunen Bhunjate.
Yugkotisahastrantu Svargaloke Meheeyate.*

He, who eats his meals quietly throughout the year, earns the merit, deserve his stay for thousands of epochs in the heaven.

यद् दूरं यद् दुरारायं यच्च दूरे व्यवस्थितम्।
तत्सर्वं तपसा सायं तपो हि दुरतिक्रमम् ॥ 33 ॥

*Yaddooram Yadduraaraaddhyam Yachcha Doore Vyavasthitam.
Tattsarva Tapasaa Saaddhyam Tapo hi Duratikramam.*

Even if the destination or the desired object be far away or difficult to achieve one can reach it or get it if one is determined. Nothing is impossible for a determined person.

RESTRAINT

इन्द्रियाणि च संयम्य बक वत् पण्डितो नरः।
देशकाल बलं ज्ञात्वा सर्वकार्याणि साध्येत् ॥ 34 ॥

*Indrayaani Cha Samyamya Bak vat Pandito Narah.
Deshkaal balam Gyattva Sarvakaaryaani Saadhyet.*

The wise man should put restraint on his sensual desires to control them and then only he should accomplish his work after assessing his strength in the context of time and space

[i.e., after cutting off the distraction caused by the sensual deviations, the wise man should enhance his strength to the hilt and then he should assess his position vis-a-vis the place and time he has to accomplish his work in.]

THE ONLY WAY

यदीच्छसि वशीकर्तुं जगदेकेनकर्मणा ।
परापवादशास्त्रोभ्यो गां चरन्तीं निवरय ॥ 35 ॥

*Yaddeechachasi Vasheekartu Jagadeken Karmana.
Paraapavaadashaastreebhyo Gaam Charanteem Nivaarya.*

If you want to overpower the entire world merely by just one action, then put restraint upon your tongue speaking ill of others.

WHO'S WHO

क्रोधो वैवस्वतो राजा तृष्णा वैतरणी नदी ।
विद्या कामदुघा धेनुः संतोषो नन्दनं वनम् ॥ 36 ॥

*Krodho Vaivasvato Raajaa Trishnaa Vaitarnee Nadee.
Vidyaa Kaamdudhaadhenuh Santosho Nandanam Vanam.*

Anger is death (i.e., lord of death Yamraj Vaivaswat), lust is (the river of hell) Vaitarani, knowledge is the cow of plenty and satisfaction is (the divine orchard) Nandanvan.

शान्तितुल्यं तपो नास्ति त सन्तोषात्परं सुखम् ।
न तृष्णया परो व्याधिर्न च धर्मो दयापरः ॥ 37 ॥

*Shaanтитुल्यam Tapo Naasti Na Santoshaatparamsukham.
Na Trishnayaaparo Vyaadhirnacha Dharmo Dayaaparah.*

No penance is greater than the one done for maintaining peace, no happiness is better than the one received from satisfaction, no disease is

more damaging than greed and no Dharma is better than the one having compassion for all.

यस्य चितं द्रवीभूतं कृपया सर्वजन्तुषु।
तस्य ज्ञानेने मोक्षेण किं जटा भस्मलेपनैः ॥ ३८ ॥

*Yasya Chittam Draveebhootam Kripayaa Sarvajantushu.
Tasya Gyanen Mokshena Kim Jataa Bhasmalepanaih.*

He, whose heart is full of compassion for all beings, does not need to seek any other knowledge, or Moksha (liberation) or care for rubbing ash all over his body (like the celebrated hermits).

ALMS-GIVING AND DONATION

देयं भोज्यधनं सुकृतिभिर्नो संचयस्तस्य वै,
श्रीकर्णस्य बलेश्च विक्रमपतेरद्यपि कीर्ति स्थिता।
अस्मकं मधुदानयोगरहितं नष्ट चिरात्संचितः
निर्वाणादिति नष्टपादयुगलं घर्षत्यमी मक्षिकाः ॥ ३९ ॥

*Deyam Bhojyadhanam Sukritibhirno Sanchayastasya Vai.
Shri Karnassya Baleshcha Vikramatreddyapi Keerti Sthitaa.
Asmaakam Madhudaanyogarahitam Nashtam Chiraatsanchitaah
Nirvaanaaditi Nashtapaadyugalam Gharshhtyamee Makshikaah.*

All great men should donate eatables and wealth. It is improper to hoard these things. The fame of Karna (of Mahabharat) and Bali (a mythological monarch renowned for his sacrifice and charity) is still unblemished because of their acts of charity. The honeybees ruefully rub their feet against ground. They neither enjoy their honey nor gifting it to others.

[Chanakya uses an allegory to bring home his point. He says the honeybees do not eat the honey, they neither collect nor give it to others. And when a person takes away their honey they fall to the ground in utter frustration.]

आर्तेषु विप्रेषु दयान्विशेच्छद्धेन यः स्वल्पमुपैति दानम्।
अनन्तपारं समुपैति दानं यद्दीयते तत्र लभेद् द्विजेभ्यः ॥ 40 ॥

*Aarteshu Vipreshu Dayaannivishchaddhena Yaha Svalpamupaiti Daanam.
Anantparam Samupaiti Daanam Yaddeeyate Tanna Labhed Dvijebyah.*

He who gives gifts and donations to the distressed and the learned gets back his these gifts many times over
[i.e., they earn great merit by these gifts because by helping-them they not only preserve life knowledge but also help in their growth.]

GIFT TO THE DESERVING

क्षीयन्ते सर्वदानानि यज्ञ होमबलि क्रियाः।
न क्षीयते पात्रादानमभयं सर्वदेहिनाम् ॥ 41 ॥

*Ksheeyante Sarvadaanaani Yagya Homabali Kriyaah.
Na Ksheeyate Paatradaanambhayam Sarvadehinaam.*

All sacrifices, gifts, donations, etc., vanish in their effect after sometime but that which is given to a deserving person survive for ever. Because the deserving receiver utilises the gifts best to further this chain of charity for the welfare of all.

DONATE LIBERALLY!

सन्तोषस्त्रिषु कर्तव्यः स्वदारे भोजने घने।
त्रिषुचैव नकर्तव्योऽध्ययने जपदानयोः ॥ ४२ ॥

*Santoshstrishu Kartavyah Svadaare Bhojane Ghane.
Trishuchaiv Na Kartavyoaddhyayane Japadaanayoh.*

One should always be satisfied (i) with his wife, (ii) with his diet and (iii) with his wealth; but never with (i) his studies, (ii) his austerity and penance and (iii) with his donations and gifts to the deserving persons.